

Ἔπη Ἀδέσποτα

Fishing and Hermes in Anonymous Greek Epic Fragments

eul_aid: aak

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Κοινή λογοτεχνική [Literary Koine](#)
Domain: Ἔπος [Epic](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Life

Epic Fragments Anonymous II is not an author but a modern cataloging label for anonymous fragments of Greek epic poetry. The assigned date range of the 8th century BCE to the 6th century CE reflects the entire span of ancient epic production, from the Archaic period through the Roman Imperial era. Such fragments typically survive as quotations in later authors or on papyri, representing a vast, mostly lost tradition of epic composition beyond the works of Homer and Hesiod.

Works

The designation refers to collections of unattributed verse fragments. These are cataloged by modern editors and originate from various sources, including poems of the lost Epic Cycle or later Hellenistic and imperial epic.

Significance

These fragments are crucial for reconstructing the breadth of Greek epic, documenting alternative mythic versions, local traditions, and the evolution of the genre. They provide primary evidence for the content of the lost Epic Cycle and testify to the continuity of epic composition across a millennium.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἀλιείας · [Fragments on Fishing](#) · 1 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἑρμοῦ · [Fragments on Hermes](#) · 7 passages